

Team Coaching Diagnostic

A 20-question diagnostic across five team dimensions — purpose, roles, processes, relationships, and external environment — with a scoring guide and coaching focus identification.

How to Use This Diagnostic

- Have each team member complete this individually and honestly, before comparing notes as a group
- Rate each statement from 1 (Strongly Disagree) to 5 (Strongly Agree), based on the team's actual current behavior, not its stated intentions
- Average scores across the team per question before scoring by dimension — individual variance is itself useful information to discuss

The Five Team Dimensions

Dimension	What It Covers
Purpose	Whether the team shares a clear, genuine understanding of why it exists and what success looks like
Roles	Whether accountability is clear, and whether roles are well-matched to individual strengths
Processes	Whether the team's ways of working — meetings, decisions, information flow — actually function
Relationships	Whether there's enough trust and psychological safety for honest disagreement and mutual support
External Environment	Whether the team has what it needs from outside itself — resources, stakeholder support, organizational context

The Diagnostic

Rate each statement: 1 (Strongly Disagree) – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 (Strongly Agree)

Purpose (Questions 1-4)

1. Every team member could describe the team's purpose in their own words, and those descriptions would largely agree. ____
2. The team has specific, shared success measures, not just a general sense of doing well. ____
3. When priorities conflict, the team's purpose provides a clear basis for deciding what matters more. ____
4. The team's purpose is reasonably stable, not something that shifts unpredictably from month to month. ____

Roles (Questions 5-8)

5. Every team member has a clear understanding of what they personally are accountable for. ____
6. There is minimal overlap or confusion about who owns a given piece of work. ____
7. Roles are matched to individual strengths, not just historical assignment or convenience. ____
8. When something falls between roles, the team has a clear way to decide who picks it up. ____

Processes (Questions 9-12)

9. Meetings have a clear purpose and consistently produce real decisions or outcomes. ____
10. The team has a clear, followed process for making decisions, not just informal consensus-seeking. ____
11. Information flows to the people who need it without requiring extra effort to track down. ____
12. The team has a working way to track and follow through on commitments made in meetings. ____

Relationships (Questions 13-16)

13. Team members can disagree openly without it damaging the working relationship afterward. ____
14. There is a real level of trust that allows people to admit mistakes or ask for help. ____
15. Team members feel safe raising a concern even if it might be unpopular. ____
16. Conflict, when it happens, tends to get resolved rather than lingering unaddressed. ____

External Environment (Questions 17-20)

17. The team has the resources (budget, tools, staffing) it genuinely needs to do its work. ____
18. Key stakeholders outside the team understand and support what the team is trying to do. ____
19. The team has enough autonomy to do its work without excessive external interference. ____
20. Organizational changes outside the team's control are communicated with enough notice and context. ____

Scoring Guide

Add the scores for each dimension's 4 questions (max 20 per dimension). Score every dimension separately — a single averaged total across all 20 questions hides which specific dimension actually needs attention.

Dimension	Questions	Max Score	Developing (below 60%)	Solid (60-80%)	Strength (above 80%)
Purpose	1-4	20	Below 12	12-15	16-20
Roles	5-8	20	Below 12	12-15	16-20
Processes	9-12	20	Below 12	12-15	16-20
Relationships	13-16	20	Below 12	12-15	16-20
External Environment	17-20	20	Below 12	12-15	16-20

The lowest-scoring dimension is usually the most useful place to start coaching — not necessarily the dimension that feels most urgent day-to-day, since urgency and root cause don't always point the same direction.

Coaching Focus Identification

Starting points based on which dimension scored lowest.

If Lowest: Purpose

Facilitate a session where the team builds a shared purpose statement from scratch, rather than having one handed down — the process of building it together matters as much as the final wording

If Lowest: Roles

Run a structured roles-and-accountabilities mapping exercise, surfacing overlaps and gaps explicitly rather than assuming they'll resolve informally

If Lowest: Processes

Audit the team's actual meeting cadence and decision-making process against what it should be — most process problems are fixed by simplifying, not adding more structure

If Lowest: Relationships

This is usually the slowest dimension to shift and often the most foundational — see the companion Conflict Resolution Toolkit and High-Performance Team Programme resources for structured approaches

If Lowest: External Environment

Map which specific external dependencies are actually blocking the team, and who has the authority to resolve each one — this dimension often requires action above the team's own level, not just within it

Re-run this diagnostic every 2-3 months while actively coaching a team — dimensions interact, and improving one (particularly Roles or Processes) often surfaces a different dimension as the next real constraint.